

Captain Zachary J. Gilbert

United States Army • Faithful Servant • Loved by Many

August 9, 1997 – September 24, 2026

A NOTICE OF PASSING

It is with unimaginable heartbreak that the Gilbert family announces the passing of **Zachary J. Gilbert**.

Zach served his country with distinction in the United States Army, earning the respect and admiration of every soldier who stood beside him.

Without warning, even to those who knew him best, Zach was overcome by a sudden and devastating mental health crisis that took him from us before we could reach him. He was taken by an illness as real and as lethal as any wound sustained on the battlefield.

Zach's family and friends are devastated by this loss, but we are also determined that his story be told honestly. We hope others may find the courage to seek help and know they are not alone.



WHO HE WAS

Zachary was the cherished firstborn son of **Carol and Jeff Gilbert**. He was later joined by his siblings, **Joshua** and **Amelia**, whom he loved dearly.

From an early age, Zach knew he wanted to serve in the United States military. At age 17, he enlisted in the Iowa Army National Guard. During his senior year at Washington High School in Cedar Rapids, Iowa, he received the extraordinary honor of an appointment to the United States Military Academy at West Point, where he graduated in 2020.

Following graduation, Zach served at Fort Benning, Fort Hood, and Fort Campbell and completed two deployments. In 2024, he achieved the rank of Captain and was looking forward to assuming command of Company B, 2-502 101st Airborne Division.

A devoted son, husband, brother, soldier, and man of deep Catholic faith, Zach possessed a genuine smile that could light up a room. He enjoyed fitness, playing guitar, and cheering on his beloved Iowa Hawkeyes and Green Bay Packers. He approached life with commitment, discipline, and a quiet strength that inspired those around him.

SURVIVED BY

Zachary is survived by his wife Alexandria, his parents and siblings; his grandparents, Veronica Benetti and Judd Gilbert; 13 aunts and uncles and their spouses; 37 cousins and their spouses; and his cousins' children. He is also mourned by his fellow soldiers and veterans, who knew exactly what kind of man he was. He was preceded in death by his grandparents, Ellie Gilbert and Arthur Benetti.

A WORD FROM HIS FAMILY

Each day, an average of 22 veterans in the United States die by suicide. We share Zach's story because we want his death to matter beyond our grief. We hope that by speaking openly about

mental health, we may help save another life. If you are a veteran, active-duty service member, or anyone who is struggling, please reach out. **You are not broken. You are needed. You are loved.**

The Veterans Crisis Line is available 24 hours a day by dialing **988 and pressing 1**, or by texting **838255**. Additional support is available through **Salute to the Fallen** at **319-777-9138**.

SERVICES & ARRANGEMENTS

A Memorial Mass with Military Honors for Zachary will be celebrated at **All Saints Catholic Church, 720 29th Street SE, Cedar Rapids, Iowa**, on Saturday October 24, 2026 at **10:30 a.m.**

Visitation will be held at All Saints Catholic Church on Friday October 23, 2026 from **5:00 p.m. to 7:00 p.m.** and will be followed by the recitation of the Holy Rosary.

Additional visitation with the family will be held on Saturday from **10:00 a.m. to 10:30 a.m.** immediately prior to the Mass.

In lieu of flowers, please direct donations in Zachary's name to <https://SalutetotheFallen.org>.

Zachary will be buried at Fort Hood Central Texas State Veterans Cemetery.

Zachary Gilbert's Favorite Scripture Verse: Psalm 23: 4

*Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death,
I will fear no evil,
for you are with me;
your rod and your staff,
they comfort me.*